Appendix A — Recommended UK Spending Personas

This appendix provides realistic UK-based customer personas for testing, demonstrations, and recommendation validation.

These personas reflect common UK spending patterns and can be used to seed SQL data, test recommendation thresholds, and drive dashboard scenarios.

Purpose

Use these personas for:

- Sprint 1 SQL seed data
- Sprint 2 carbon calculation testing
- Sprint 2 recommendation testing
- Sprint 3 dashboard visualisation
- Sprint 4 showcase demonstrations

Persona 1 — Single Professional

Profile:

A working adult living alone in a UK city.

Typical characteristics:

- rents accommodation
- regular commuting
- moderate food spending
- moderate utilities

Typical monthly spend:

- Travel: £280
- Food: £320
- Utilities: £140

Common behaviours:

- daily commuting
- takeaway meals
- occasional public transport

Likely recommendations:

- reduce car journeys
- use meal prep more often

Persona 2 — Family Household

Profile:

Two adults with children.

Typical characteristics:

- larger food spend
- school transport
- higher utilities usage

Typical monthly spend:

- Travel: £450
- Food: £650
- Utilities: £260

Common behaviours:

- family car usage
- supermarket shopping
- high home energy usage

Likely recommendations:

- reduce unnecessary car journeys
- optimise food planning
- reduce heating usage

Persona 3 — Student

Profile:

University student living in shared accommodation.

Typical characteristics:

- low travel spend

- lower utilities contribution
- moderate food spend

Typical monthly spend:

- Travel: £120
- Food: £180
- Utilities: £70

Common behaviours:

- public transport
- low-cost groceries
- shared utility bills

Likely recommendations:

- reduce takeaway spending
- batch cook meals

Persona 4 — Retired Couple

Profile:

Retired household with stable spending patterns.

Typical characteristics:

- low travel
- moderate food
- higher home energy usage

Typical monthly spend:

- Travel: £90
- Food: £280
- Utilities: £180

Common behaviours:

- home-based lifestyle
- consistent grocery spend

- higher heating use

Likely recommendations:

- reduce heating usage
- energy efficiency improvements

Persona 5 — High Commuter

Profile:

Working adult with long-distance commuting.

Typical characteristics:

- high travel spend
- moderate food
- moderate utilities

Typical monthly spend:

- Travel: £520
- Food: £340
- Utilities: £160

Common behaviours:

- frequent car use
- fuel-heavy commuting
- motorway travel

Likely recommendations:

- car share
- hybrid working
- public transport alternatives

Threshold Testing

Use personas to validate recommendation triggers.

Travel threshold:

£300

Food threshold:

£250

Utilities threshold:

£150

Example Recommendation Triggers

Travel:

If spend exceeds £300:

- reduce car journeys
- use public transport
- car share

Food:

If spend exceeds £250:

- meal prep
- reduce takeaway purchases
- batch cook

Utilities:

If spend exceeds £150:

- reduce heating
- switch off unused devices
- optimise appliance usage

SQL Seed Example

```
INSERT INTO Customers (CustomerId, PersonaType)
VALUES
(1001, 'Single Professional'),
(1002, 'Family Household'),
(1003, 'Student'),
(1004, 'Retired Couple'),
(1005, 'High Commuter');
```

Recommended Demo Use

Use:

- Single Professional for balanced demos
- Family Household for high-impact demos
- Student for low-impact demos
- Retired Couple for utilities-focused demos
- High Commuter for travel-heavy demos